CHRIS BLAIR

PRODUCT DESIGN LEADER

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PROFILE

Product design leader with 15+ years designing consumer, fintech, SaaS, and AI products and 8+ years building and leading design teams. Scaled Greenlight's design team from 3 to 14 and led a redesign that lifted plan upgrades 10% and cut downgrades 10%, then built Airia's design function from scratch. Stays hands-on as a player-coach, pairing user research with product metrics, holding a high bar for interaction and visual craft, and running an AI-first practice across Figma, Storybook, and Claude Code.

Best fit for teams that want a design leader who can set direction, grow designers, partner with executives, and still get into the work.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Measurable product impact.** Led a research-driven redesign of Greenlight's navigation and information architecture: plan upgrades up 10%, downgrades down 10%, Safety Hub visits doubled, lesson completions up 5%, and support contacts down 5%.
- **Design org building and scaling.** Scaled Greenlight's design team from 3 to 14 designers, building the hiring, onboarding, and leveling structure that let design keep pace with a high-growth fintech.
- **0 to 1 function creation.** Joined Airia as its first design leader, stood up the design function, including the team, rituals, and design system, and led the team's move to AI-first workflows.
- **AI product design.** Directed the redesign of Airia's AI chat experience, including deep thinking mode, file and slide creation, and automated tasks, shaping the product vision for agentic AI workflows across roughly 500 enterprise customers.
- **Design system as shared infrastructure.** Partnered with engineering to connect Airia's Figma library to Storybook and Claude Code, making live code the source of truth and surfacing drift automatically.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer (Contract) · 42gen

May 2026 – Aug 2026 · Boston, MA (Remote)

Led design for the Argo mobile and web applications at a startup, defining the design language and system, mapping core user flows, and shaping key features and journeys across the experience. Established qualitative user testing practices and applied AI extensively throughout the design process.

- Created and evaluated a set of user personas, aligning a stalled product team on inventory and property management for the Argo home management app, and converting features into a defined product strategy and roadmap.

Head of Product Design · Airia

Feb 2024 – May 2026 · Atlanta, GA

Design leader and player-coach who built a product design function from scratch, hiring and managing a distributed team of up to eight designers across Latin America. Established design review practices and collaborated closely with Product and Engineering to integrate design into core product decisions. Led multiple projects while remaining hands-on, and introduced AI to enhance team workflows and personal design execution, improving output organization-wide.

- Scaled adoption with ~500 enterprise customers by redesigning the AI chat experience for consumer-grade usability and security, and launching features like deep thinking mode, file and slide creation, and automated tasks to shape the product vision for agentic AI workflows.
- Established a connected design system spanning Figma, Storybook, and Claude Code that enforced consistent UX and surfaced drift automatically, setting strategic direction with design leadership to raise the quality bar as AI tooling accelerated build velocity.

Greenlight Financial Technology

Atlanta, GA · Jan 2020 – Jan 2024 · Consumer fintech app for kids and families

Senior Director, Product Design

Jan 2022 – Jan 2024

Managed and grew a 14-person design team, including the team responsible for lessons, chores, and growth experimentation, expanding capabilities across cross-functional collaboration, design system maturity, user research, and new project exploration.

- Drove a 10% lift in plan upgrades and a 10% drop in downgrades, doubled Safety Hub visits, and cut support contacts 5% by leading a research-driven redesign of the app's navigation and information architecture that improved feature discovery across the platform.

Director, Product Design

Jan 2021 – Jan 2022

Directed UX design across the entire product surface while building the design team, staffing cross-functional teams, and keeping initiatives on track. Ran design reviews and team rituals to sustain a consistently high quality bar.

- Grew the design team from 3 to 14 by creating a growth plan, justifying headcount, and implementing weekly cadences to manage design debt during rapid growth while mentoring and fostering career development.

Senior Product Designer

Jan 2020 – Jan 2021

Designed end-to-end flows for core user journeys, including chores, allowance, and card management, supporting an ongoing redesign effort in close collaboration with the VP of Design. Partnered with the Brand team to deliver a seamless customer experience across touchpoints.

Lead Designer · Drum

Jan 2020 – Jun 2020 · Atlanta, GA

Lead designer for Scout, a consumer social recommendation app, conducting design sprints, creating prototypes, designing user flows and roadmaps, and working with developers. Collaborated with a Ukrainian team and managed a local designer.

- Secured stakeholder alignment on the Scout app with a clear product roadmap and prototypes, using design thinking and rapid prototyping to focus the team on core features and user flows through strong communication skills that built cross-functional trust and influence.

Senior Product Designer · Mailchimp (now Intuit)

May 2015 – Jan 2020 · Atlanta, GA

Served as Product Designer across multiple cross-functional teams spanning enterprise email (Mandrill), developer support, ecommerce, audience management, and Mailchimp.com. Designed and tested user flows, conducted user research, partnered with content designers on Mailchimp.com, and contributed to in-app branding.

- Conducted a 20-participant study and multi-survey campaign with a third-party partner to gather tagging, demographic, and location data for a comprehensive audience management redesign, demonstrating creativity in research design and communication with stakeholders to assess users' perception of the platform as a CRM.
- Refreshed brand expression across the core application by co-creating and rolling out a new illustration system that carried the product until a full brand refresh two years later, and was widely imitated industry-wide.
- Boosted usage of Mailchimp's pop-up form builder through a full redesign that made list-building easier, and extended the new pattern to rebuild the additional four sign-up form types on that foundation.

UX Design Lead · AirWatch by VMware (now Workspace ONE UEM)

Jan 2012 – Apr 2015 · Atlanta, GA

Set UX direction and oversaw design projects across an enterprise admin console and end-user mobile applications, leading a distributed team of 6 designers across local and India-based locations. Operated as a player-coach, contributing directly as Design Lead alongside management responsibilities.

- Led the redesign and rebuild of a rigid proprietary platform onto open standards, breaking through a platform-wide UX quality ceiling while personally owning both the UX design and the entire front-end codebase to demonstrate design leadership and mastery of end-to-end delivery.
- Co-led an autonomous ground-up redesign of the platform's navigation and core product areas, clearing accumulated UX debt and delivering a flagship release that the founder credited as a contributing factor in the company's ~$1.5B acquisition while strengthening product strategy across core journeys.

Early career

Web Designer · Southern Web Group (now SiteCare) · Multimedia Designer · AL.com

CAPABILITIES

Professional & leadership: Product Design Leadership · Visual Design · Interaction Design · AI Product Design · AI Adoption & Change Management · Behavioral Design · Experimentation & A/B Testing · Growth Design · Content Design Partnership · Consumer Fintech · Consumer Apps · Growth & Engagement · Design Systems · Design Operations (DesignOps) · UX Research · Usability Testing · Product Strategy · Product Discovery · Information Architecture · UI Design · Prototyping · Mobile App Design · AI-Augmented Workflows · 0 to 1 Product Development · Executive Partnership · Cross-Functional Leadership · Stakeholder Management · Team Building & Mentorship · Hiring and Talent Development · Roadmap Planning · Accessibility · Design Quality Governance

Software & applications: Figma · Figma Make · FigJam · Cursor · Google Stitch · Claude Code · Claude Design · Claude Cowork · ChatGPT · Gemini · Perplexity Computer · Lovable · Adobe Creative Suite · Google Suite · Microsoft Office

Languages: HTML · CSS · JavaScript **Systems:** Mac OS · Windows

Methodologies: Agile · Scrum · AI-first design & development · Design systems

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts, Industrial Design · Auburn University, Auburn, AL

Associate Degree, Internet Webmaster Technician · Virginia College at Birmingham

Certification: Mobile App Design Bootcamp

RECOGNITION

Interactive Programmer of the Year, Peak 2006 · Birmingham Advertising Federation

Patent: Display screen with a graphical user interface for a management console application